

UTT Chapter 06 Assignment

Hello again!

I finally have enough time to write you! Midterms were just as rough as I thought they would be. I mean, tests in high school were hard too, but these were just brutal. Anyway, intramurals are pretty much over for a little while, which is half-sad and half-relieving. Even though it was fun, it took a lot of time.

I had a funny experience today at the cafeteria! Apparently, there's a tradition at our school that everyone in the cafeteria claps when someone drops a dish. Unfortunately, today was my turn for a standing ovation. I didn't just drop a fork or spill a little soda either. I made a scene! I slipped on a wet spot and went right down onto the floor with every item from my lunch tray following. When I looked down, I was wearing my lunch. I stood up and took a bow and everyone clapped. It was pretty funny even though it was little embarrassing as well.

When I got back to my room to change, Nathan was talking on the phone with a friend of his. From what I gathered, he was giving his friend advice about some crisis he was going through. At first I thought Nathan was talking about God, but then I heard him tell his friend to spend some time meditating and "emptying his mind." I didn't catch everything Nathan said (or maybe I just didn't understand what he was saying), but I clearly heard him say "life is suffering" and that the solution to our suffering could be found within us. Nathan told his friend to practice "emptying himself" and to "reconnect with the divine consciousness." None of that seemed very comforting to me, but it made me curious.

Later I asked my friend Sarah about it. She said Nathan is into to "New Spirituality" and that he reads too much Eastern religious literature. She said it is all a bunch of . . . well, it doesn't rhyme with baloney, but it basically means the same thing!

I bet you know about Nathan's beliefs! I know it has something to do with God, but I have no idea what Nathan was saying about consciousness. **What does New Spirituality teach about God and consciousness?** It doesn't sound Christian, but then again, I'm not sure what it sounds like. **What does New Spirituality say about humanity?** And **what does New Spirituality say is wrong with us?** It sounded like meditation and "becoming one with the universe" is some kind of cure-all for problems. **What does New Spirituality say about how we should live?**

You're basically my worldview dictionary. It's pretty awesome. I hope you don't mind! I'll talk to you later. I'm meeting up with everyone in the Commons for a Ping-Pong tournament.

Bye!

-Doug